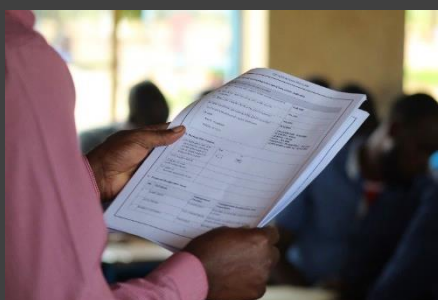




REPUBLIC OF ZAMBIA

MINISTRY OF HOME AFFAIRS AND INTERNAL SECURITY



STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURES FOR THE DEVOLVED DISTRICT ARCHIVES FUNCTION FOR LOCAL AUTHORITIES



AUGUST, 2024

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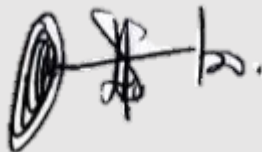
FOREWORD

In accordance with the Constitution of Zambia (Amendment) Act No. 2 of 2016, the National Decentralisation Policy of 2023, and Cabinet Office Circular No. 2 of 2023, the Ministry of Home Affairs and Internal Security has successfully devolved the District Archives function to Local Authorities. This Decentralisation initiative aims to enhance service delivery by bringing essential services closer to the people.

The devolution of the District Archives function involves the establishment of local archives to survey, appraise, and store closed personnel, procurement, financial, and patient records. Effective records management ensures proper creation, organization, storage, and disposal of these records to meet legal, operational, and historical needs. By decentralizing this function, the Ministry seeks to improve service delivery and accessibility for citizens.

I am, therefore, elated at the successful development of these Standard Operating Procedures to guide Local Authorities in the effective management and operation of the devolved District Archives function. These SOPs will ensure that local authorities can efficiently handle the responsibilities associated with this important task.

The Ministry is highly indebted to all those who contributed to the successful development of these Standard Operating Procedures.



Dickson Matembo (Mr.)
PERMANENT SECRETARY-CRIAR

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WORKING DEFINITIONS

Accession Number	A unique identifier assigned to a group of records transferred to an archive
Archival Records	Records with enduring value that are preserved for historical, legal, or research purposes.
Digitized Archival Materials	Electronic copies of original archival records
District Archives	A dedicated facility within a local authority for storing and preserving archival records
Location Number	A code assigned to identify the physical location of a box of records within the storage facility
Record Series	A group of related records arranged according to a filing system or classification scheme
Record Survey	A systematic examination of records to identify their volume, format, condition, and retention requirements
Reference Services	The services provided by an archive to assist researchers and the public in accessing and using archival materials.
Retention Period	The length of time a record must be kept before it can be disposed of.
Semi-Current Records	Records no longer actively used in daily operations but potentially needed for reference

INTRODUCTION

The following Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) outline the essential guidelines for managing archival records within local authorities in Zambia. These procedures have been established in response to the devolution of district archives responsibilities from the National Archives of Zambia (NAZ) to Local Authorities. Record management is essential for maintaining a well-organized and accessible archive that supports legal compliance, efficient operations, and historical preservation.

This comprehensive guide is divided into three distinct SOPs, each focusing on a specific aspect of archival management:

- i. **Standard Operating Procedures for Archival Records:** This SOP details the processes for managing non-policy records within local authorities, including their creation, classification, storage, retrieval, and disposal.
- ii. **Reference Services:** This SOP outlines the procedures for managing and providing reference services for digitised archival materials held by local authorities.
- iii. **Building a District Archives:** This SOP outlines the procedures for establishing a dedicated District Archives facility within local authorities, ensuring the secure storage and preservation of vital records.

By adhering to these SOPs, local authorities can effectively manage their archival records, ensuring accessibility for both government departments and the public while complying with relevant regulations.

1.0 PROCEDURES FOR ARCHIVAL RECORDS

1.1 Introduction

This SOP outlines procedures for managing records within local authorities, following the transfer of this function from the National Archives of Zambia (NAZ). Effective records management ensures proper creation, organization, storage, and disposal of records to meet legal, operational, and historical needs.

1.2 Scope

This SOP applies to non-policy records created by local authorities or received from other government institutions, regardless of format (paper, electronic, audio-visual). This includes:

- i. Personnel files
- ii. Financial records
- iii. Procurement files
- iv. Patient files

Exceptions: Personnel files for prominent government officials (District Commissioners, Ambassadors, Permanent Secretaries, etc.) are not included.

1.3 Purpose

- i. Establish a systematic approach for local authority record management.
- ii. Ensure efficient retrieval of semi-current records by the creating department.
- iii. Ensure efficient access to digitized historical records for the public.
- iv. Comply with legal and regulatory requirements for record keeping.
- v. Preserve key records like personnel files, financial records, procurement files, and patient files.

1.4 Roles and Responsibilities

1.4.1 Archivist (Records Management Officer):

- i. Leads the Records Management program, overseeing all aspects of record keeping.
- ii. Conducts record surveys in government institutions to identify records for transfer to the District Archives.
- iii. Liaises with departments and registry personnel to ensure proper record creation and classification.
- iv. Advises on best practices and adherence to relevant standards.
- v. Coordinates collection, classification, and shelving of semi-current records for archival storage.

-
- vi. Collaborates with personnel to ensure efficient record retrieval upon request.
 - vii. Submits budget requests to secure funding for activities like purchasing storage materials or specialized equipment.

1.4.2 Assistant Archivist:

- i. Assists the Archivist with record keeping tasks (data entry, filing, retrieval).
- ii. Retrieves semi-current records promptly to facilitate access to information.
- iii. Shelves semi-current records efficiently for easy retrieval.
- iv. Prepares statistics on semi-current record use to assess their value.

1.4.3 Assistant Conservator:

- i. Performs record treatment and repair.
- ii. Creates preventive preservation programs to protect records.
- iii. Maintains conservation chemicals, equipment, and materials.
- iv. Manages disaster preparedness activities to prevent potential damage.

1.4.4 Department of Finance:

- i. Reviews budget requests from the Archivist for records management activities, ensuring alignment with financial goals and resource availability.
- ii. Allocates funding upon budget approval to facilitate the program.

1.4.5 Government Departments:

- i. Collaborates with the Archivist to transfer relevant records to the local authority archives, as needed.

1.5 Procedures

1.5.1 Record Creation and Classification

- i. Departments are responsible for creating and maintaining accurate and complete records of their activities.
- ii. Records must be classified according to a standardized system for easy organization and retrieval.
- iii. The Archivist collaborates with departments to ensure proper classification.

1.5.2 Record Surveys

- i. The Archivist will periodically conduct record surveys to identify and assess records across all departments using a Record Survey Sheet.
- ii. Surveys will help determine volume, format, condition, and retention requirements of records.

1.5.3 Collection and Shelving

- i. Semi-current records no longer actively used but potentially needed for reference will be collected by the Archivist for storage.
- ii. Records will be classified and shelved according to their series in a secure and environmentally controlled storage facility.
- iii. Each box of records will have a location number assigned, consisting of:
 - a. Bay number
 - b. Shelf number
 - c. Row number
 - d. Front/rear location indicator
 - e. Running box number

As illustrated below:



- iv. Boxes will have a Storage Box Label indicating the department, period covered, box number, location number, and record description.
- v. Bays should be clearly numbered.
- vi. Shelves must be 15 centimeters from the floor.

1.5.4 Transfer of Records:

- i. Initiated by government departments and completed by the District Archives.

1.5.5 Government Departments:

- i. Identify files for transfer to the District Archives.
- ii. Sort files into record series.
- iii. Ensure all files are in folders before transfer.
- iv. Check files for signs of insect infestation or mold.
- v. List records on Transmittal Forms (Appendix 1) in triplicate.
- vi. Large records (e.g., registers) should be tied in bundles and listed on the Transmittal Forms.
- vii. Place files in boxes with two transmittal lists.
- viii. Use standard boxes with specified dimensions (37cm x 28cm x 27cm).

Packing Tips:

- ✓ Avoid overpacking or under packing boxes.
- ✓ Do not place additional materials on the bottom, sides, or top of the records.

1.5.6 Records Storage Facility:

- i. Verify files in boxes match the Transmittal Form.
- ii. Assign an accession number to the transfer.
- iii. Assign a location number and box number to each box.
- iv. Place boxes on designated shelves.

1.5.7 Access and Retrieval

Creating departments can access records by submitting a formal request to the Archivist, stating the location number of the requested record.

Please Note: Semi-current records are not accessible to the public and can only be accessed by the department that created them.

- i. The Archivist will retrieve requested records within a reasonable timeframe, following established procedures for access and confidentiality. The requesting department will fill out the Request for Records Form (Appendix 2).
- ii. The Archivist will record details of the requesting department in the Consultation Register, including the name of the officer requesting information, contact details, retrieval and return dates.

1.6 Disposition

Records that have reached the end of their retention period will be disposed of securely, following established procedures to ensure information security and compliance with relevant regulations (e.g., shredding and incineration).

1.6 Training and Awareness

- i. The National Archives of Zambia (NAZ) will provide capacity building programs for archivists in the District Archives on proper record keeping practices and the importance of Records Management.
- ii. Regular communication will be maintained to raise awareness about the records management program and its benefits.

1.7 Review and Update

This SOP will be reviewed and updated periodically to reflect changes in legislation, best practices, and the local authority's recordkeeping needs.

2.0 PROCEDURES FOR REFERENCE SERVICES

2.1 Introduction

This SOP outlines procedures for managing and providing reference services for digitized archival materials in LAs, following the transfer of this function from the National Archives of Zambia (NAZ). This will improve access to historical records for researchers and the public within districts.

2.2 Scope

This SOP applies to all digitized archival materials transferred from the NAZ to the LAs.

2.3 Purpose

To provide efficient reference services for researchers and the public interested in accessing digitized archival materials.

2.4 Roles and Responsibilities

2.4.1 Archivist

- i. Leads the archives administration and reference program.
- ii. Manages the archival database, ensuring its security and integrity.
- iii. Provides reference services to researchers and the public, assisting them in locating and accessing relevant archival materials.
- iv. Collaborates with the Department of Finance and Procurement Unit to secure necessary resources for archival activities.

2.4.2 Assistant Archivists

- i. Assists with providing reference services to researchers and the public.

2.4.3 Department of Finance

- i. Reviews budget requests submitted by the Archivist for archives administration and reference activities, considering alignment with overall financial goals and resource availability.
- ii. Allocates funding for approved activities, such as purchasing archival storage hardware or software.

2.4.3 Procurement Unit

- i. Works closely with the Archivist to procure necessary equipment, materials, and software for digitization, archival storage, and reference services.
- ii. Follows established procurement procedures to ensure cost-effectiveness and timely acquisition of resources.

2.5 Procedures

2.5.1 Researcher Requirements

- i. Government researchers must present an introductory letter from their institution. Reference services are free for government researchers.
- ii. Individual researchers must pay a prescribed fee (see Appendix 3).

2.5.2 Preservation

- i. Digitized materials will be stored on secure and reliable storage media to ensure long-term accessibility.
- ii. Regular backups will be performed to protect against data loss.

2.5.3 Reference Services

- i. The Archivist will provide reference services to researchers and the public interested in accessing digitized archival materials.
- ii. This may involve:
 - a. Assisting with search strategies (e.g., keyword search, browsing by collection)
 - b. Navigating the online archive (if applicable)
 - c. Interpreting historical documents

2.6 Training and Awareness

- i. The Archivist will participate in ongoing professional development to stay updated on best practices in digital archives management.
- ii. Training sessions may be conducted for staff on accessing and using the digitized archival collections.

2.7 Review and Update

This SOP will be reviewed and updated periodically to reflect changes in technology, best practices, and user needs.

3.0 PROCEDURES FOR BUILDING A DISTRICT ARCHIVES

3.1 Introduction

This SOP outlines the procedures for building a District Archives within local authorities, following the devolution of this function from the National Archives of Zambia (NAZ). A purposely built facility will ensure proper storage and preservation of records.

3.2 Scope

This SOP applies to all District Archives under Local Authorities, for storing personnel, financial, procurement, patient, and digital records. Personnel files for prominent government officials (e.g., District Commissioners, Ambassadors, Permanent Secretaries) follow separate protocols.

3.3 Purpose

- i. Establish a purposely built District Archives facility.
- ii. Securely store records for safekeeping.
- iii. Preserve historical documents for future generations.
- iv. Extend the lifespan of stored records

3.4 Roles and Responsibilities

3.4.1 Archivist

- i. Assess the need for a new District Archives facility based on current storage capacity and record volume projections.
- ii. Collaborate with the Department of Engineering to develop a building plan that meets archival storage requirements.
- iii. Prepare a detailed budget proposal outlining construction costs, equipment needs, and operational expenses in liaison with the Department of Engineering.
- iv. Work with the National Archives of Zambia (NAZ) to secure funding and technical support.
- v. Liaise with the Procurement Unit on equipment and furniture acquisition.
- vi. Oversee construction progress and ensure adherence to specifications.

3.4.2 Department of Engineering

- i. Provide technical expertise in site selection, architectural design, and construction methods that meet archival storage best practices.

-
- ii. Review and approve building plans in accordance with building codes and safety regulations.
 - iii. Oversee the construction process and ensure quality control.

3.4.3 Department of Finance

- i. Review the budget proposal submitted by the Archivist and ensure alignment with financial goals and resource availability.
- ii. Allocate funding upon budget approval to facilitate the project.
- iii. Monitor project expenditures throughout the construction process.

3.4.5 Procurement Unit

- i. Oversee the procurement of all materials, equipment, and furniture needed for the District Archives construction and operation.
- ii. Issue tenders, evaluate bids, and select qualified vendors in accordance with established procurement procedures.
- iii. Ensure timely acquisition of necessary resources within budget constraints.

3.4.6 National Archives of Zambia

- i. Collaborate with the local authority on project development, providing technical guidance and expertise on archival storage standards.
- ii. Advocate for funding for District Archives construction through the Ministry of Finance and National Planning.
- iii. Offer technical support throughout the project lifecycle, including design review, construction oversight, and staff training.

3.5 Procedure

3.5.1 Site Selection and Planning:

- i. The Archivist and Engineering department work together to identify a suitable plot considering:
 - a. Accessibility
 - b. Distance from environmental hazards (e.g., floods, termites)
 - c. Space for future expansion (minimum 100 x 100 meters)
 - d. Legal considerations (permits, land ownership)
- ii. A detailed building plan incorporates features like:
 - a. Secure repository with temperature and humidity control (13-20°C)
 - b. Processing room for record preparation and conservation

-
- c. Search room with researcher access (tables, chairs, computers)
 - d. Staff offices
 - e. Loading bay for efficient record movement
 - f. Secure storage for digital records
 - g. Staff restrooms with showers
 - h. Kitchen for staff convenience

3.5.2 Construction Specifications:

- i. The building design adheres to relevant building codes and safety regulations.
- ii. Construction materials are chosen for durability, fire resistance, and resistance to pests and environmental damage.
- iii. The building is equipped with:
 - a. Fire safety systems (extinguishers, sprinklers, smoke detectors)
 - b. Security systems (alarms, access control)
 - c. Climate control systems (air conditioning, dehumidifiers)

3.6 Security Procedures

Access to the District Archives will be restricted and controlled. A security plan will be established, outlining protocols for entry, surveillance, and record handling.

3.7 Budgeting and Procurement

- i. The Archivist working in liaison with the Department of Engineering will prepare a comprehensive budget proposal outlining:
 - a. Construction costs (materials, labor, equipment).
 - b. Furniture and equipment needs.
 - c. Operational expenses (utilities, maintenance).
- ii. The Department of Finance will review the budget and allocate funding upon approval.
- iii. The Procurement Unit will oversee the procurement of all necessary resources, ensuring adherence to established procedures and cost-effectiveness.

3.8 Timeline

- i. A realistic timeline for the project will be established, including key milestones for
 - a. Site selection and planning (e.g., 3 months)
 - b. Building plan development and approval (e.g., 2 months)
 - c. Budget approval and funding allocation (e.g., 1 month)
 - d. Tendering and procurement process (e.g., 3 months)
 - e. Construction phase (duration will depend on project complexity)
 - f. Equipment and furniture installation (e.g., 1 month)
 - g. Staff training (e.g., 1 month)

3.9 Sustainability

- i. Sustainable practices will be incorporated where feasible, such as:
 - a. Energy-efficient lighting and climate control systems.
 - b. Solar power.
 - c. Use of locally sourced building materials.

3.10. Project Completion and Handover

Upon completion, the Engineering department will conduct a final inspection to ensure adherence to specifications. The District Archives will be formally handed over to the local authority for operation and maintenance.

3.11. Training and Awareness

- i. Staff involved in managing the District Archives will receive training on:
 - a. Archival best practices for record storage and preservation.
 - b. Emergency preparedness procedures.
 - c. Security protocols.
 - d. User services and assisting researchers.

3.12. Review and Update

This SOP will be reviewed and updated periodically to reflect changes in:

- i. Legislation and building codes.
- ii. Archival best practices.
- iii. Local authority needs.

4.0 THE ROLE THE NATIONAL ARCHIVES OF ZAMBIA IN THE DEVOLVED DISTRICT ARCHIVES FUNCTION.

Following the devolution of District Archives function to the local authorities (LAs), the Ministry of Homes Affairs and Internal Security through the National Archives of Zambia will retain oversight. Here is how the National Archives of Zambia will collaborate with Las to ensure effective performance of the devolved District Archives function:

4.1 Policy Formulation and Guidance

MHAIS through NAZ will take the lead in developing and establishing national policies and guidelines for managing records within local authorities. These policies will ensure consistency and adherence to best practices across all districts.

4.2 Resource Mobilization

NAZ through MHAIS will play a crucial role in advocating for funding for District Archives construction and operations. This will involve:

- i. NAZ through the MHAIS working closely with LAs to assess their financial needs for the performance of the District Archives Function.
- ii. Advocating for appropriate budgetary allocations within the national budget to support LAs' community sports functions.
- iii. Engaging with the Ministry of Finance and National Planning to highlight the importance of community sport and the need for sufficient funding.
- iv. MHAIS will conduct periodic financial audits and assessments to ensure the appropriate use of funds allocated for District Archives activities by LAs. MHAIS will develop and disseminate best practices for financial transparency and accountability.

4.3 Monitoring and Ensuring Adherence to Standards

NAZ will oversee the performance of District Archives, ensuring they adhere to established national standards for record keeping, storage, and preservation. This might involve conducting inspections or audits.

4.4 Capacity Building

NAZ will provide training and capacity building programs for archivists and staff working in the District Archives. This ensures they have the necessary knowledge and skills to effectively manage records.

In essence, NAZ acts as a central body that provides overarching guidance, secures resources, monitors performance, and strengthens the capacity of local authorities to manage devolved district archives functions effectively. This collaborative approach ensures a standardized and efficient record-keeping system across all districts in Zambia.

Appendices

Appendix 1: Records Transmittal List

NATIONAL ARCHIVES OF ZAMBIA RECORDS TRANSMITTAL LIST

Page No.

Consignment No.

(To be completed in triplicate)

Department/Office.....

Pkg. No.	File no.	Description of records	Covering Dates		For Records Centre Use		
			From	To	Destruction Date	Location	Box No.

Records listed by:

Name.....

Date.....

**Consignment received, Checked and
processed by:**

Name.....

Date.....

Appendix 2: Request for Records Form

**NATIONAL ARCHIVES OF ZAMBIA
RECORDS CENTRE**

For Records Centre Use

REQUEST FOR RECORDS
(To be completed in duplicate)

Request No.

Department/Office.....

Date.....

Address for delivery.....

Requested by:

Anticipated date of return:

Records Centre No.....

Location Box No-----

Description

For Records Centre Use

Telephone request

Records sent to

Records issued at

Date of

Received by:

Dept by:

Records Centre by:

Reminder

Appendix 3: Schedule of Fees



MINISTRY OF HOME AFFAIRS & INTERNAL SECURITY DEPARTMENT OF NATIONAL ARCHIVES OF ZAMBIA

REVISION OF NATIONAL ARCHIVES FEES

The National Archives fees have been revised upwards effective 24th May, 2024.

			Old Fees ZMK	News Fees ZMK
1	For Supplying documents facsimile by photocopying process:			
	a	Quarto Sheet	10.00	13.33
	b	Foolscap	10.00	13.33
	c	Large Sheet	10.00	13.33
2	Research Fees:			
	a	Research 12 Months		
		(i) Foreigners	2,000.0 0	2,666.6 6
		(ii) Citizen	300.00	400.00
		(iii) Under- graduates Zambian Students	200.00	266.66
	b	Research 6 Months		
		(i) Foreigners	1,500.0 0	2,000.0 0
		(ii) Citizen	250.00	333.33
		(iii) Under- graduates Zambian Students	150.00	200.00

	c	Research 3 Months		
		(i) Foreigners	1,000.00	1,333.33
		(ii) Citizen	200.00	266.66
		(iii) Under-graduates Zambian Students	120.00	160.00
3		Quick Reference		
	a	Foreigners	500.00	666.66
	b	Citizen	250.00	333.33
4		Registration of Periodicals		
	a	New Registration	1,500.00	2000.00
	b	Amendment to existing Registration	500.00	666.66
5		Exhibitions		
	a	Foreigners	200.00	266.66
	b	Citizen-Adult (Above 16 years)	150.00	200.00
	c	Citizen-Children (Below 16 years)	150.00	200.00
	d	School Groups	120.00	160.00
6		Readers or students using main Library with own materials for 3 months	150.00	200.00



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